

AI Use and Attitudes in the Fire & Emergency Service: Insights and Opportunities

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Session Roadmap



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Actionable
Research



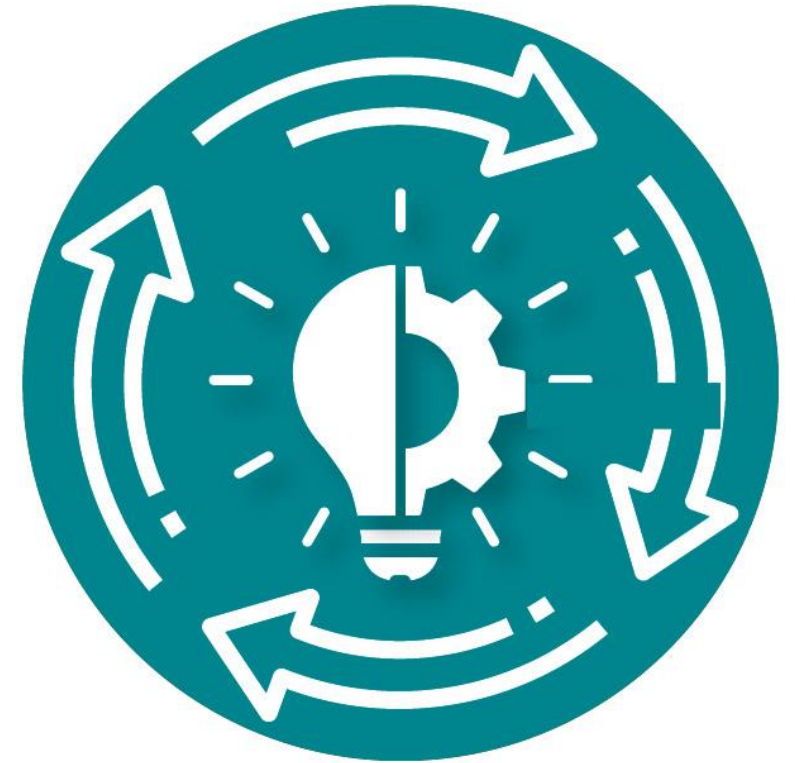
Insight Hub



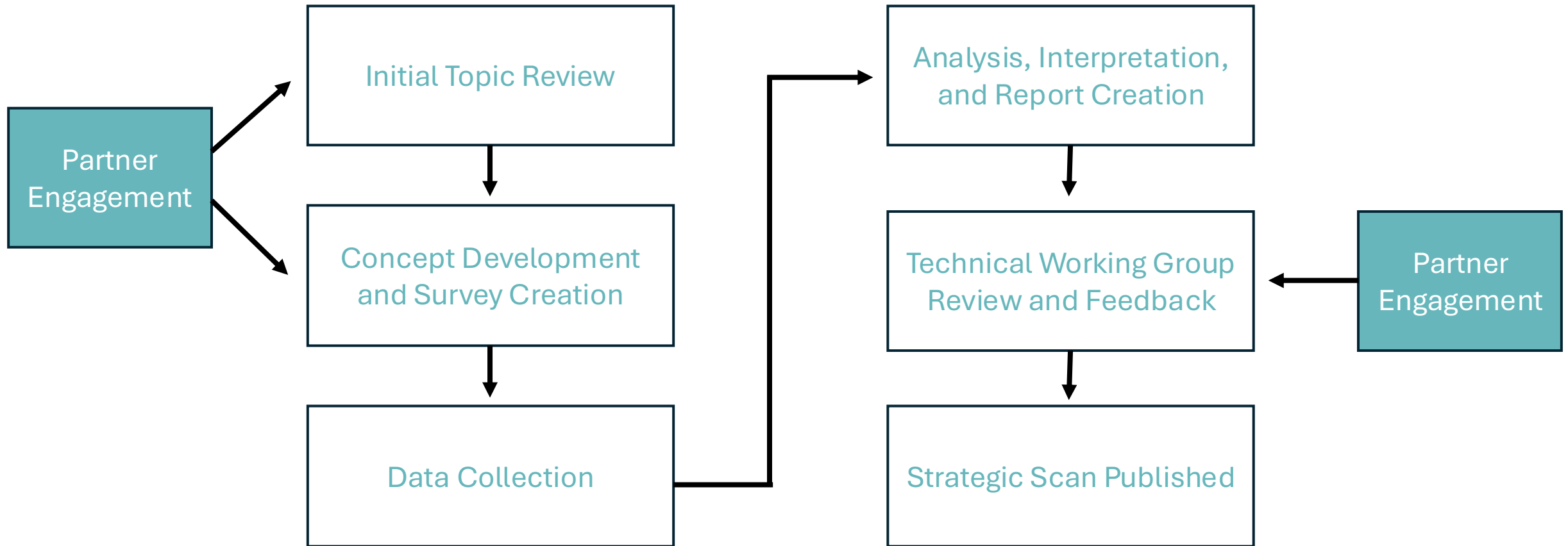
Expert Finder

Actionable Research – From Theory to Action

- Provides actionable recommendations and implementation strategies to address challenges by working with prominent researchers.
- By conducting new public administration and public policy research, we will assist the fire and emergency service in solving problems before they become a crisis.



Strategic Scans: Process



Technical Working Group

Name	Department	State
Chief Jonathan Killings	El Paso Fire Department	Texas
Chief Donald Lombardi (Ret.)	West Metro Fire Protection District	Colorado
Chief Jason Wells	Lexington Fire Department	Kentucky
Chief Brad Brown	Grand Rapids Fire Department	Michigan
Chief Digna Abello	Miami Beach Fire Department	Florida
Chief Holger Durre	Prescott Fire Department	Arizona
Chief Daniel Curia	Charleston Fire Department	South Carolina

Partnerships

- Accredited fire departments
- Credentialed fire professionals
- Marist University
- Center for Public Safety Excellence



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Strategic Scans: Past Topics

1. Use of and Attitudes towards AI in the Fire and Emergency Service
2. FD Leadership Perspectives on Apparatus Capital Purchasing
3. Community Needs and Co-responder Programs



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Strategic Scan

Use of and Attitudes towards
Artificial Intelligence in the Fire
and Emergency Service

In partnership with



MARIST
UNIVERSITY

Survey Respondents

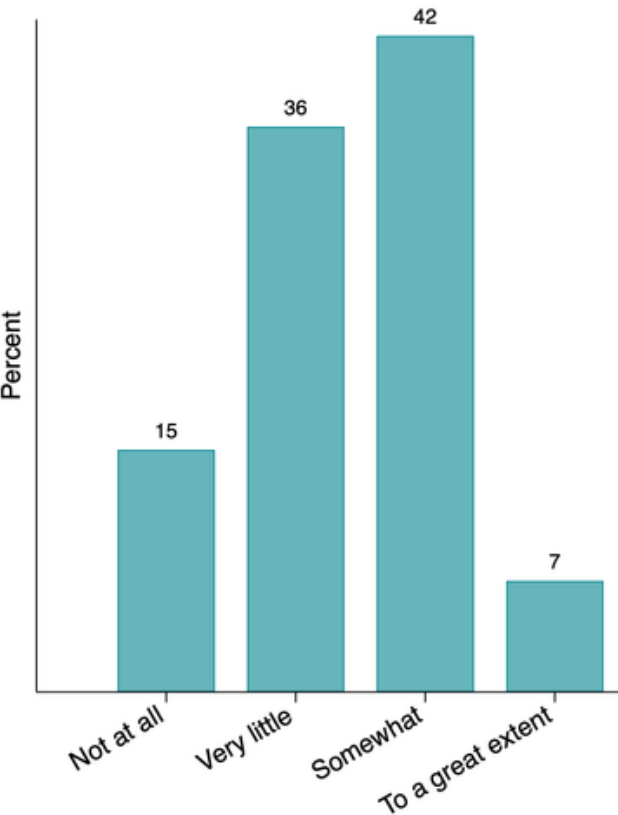
- Data were collected in **July 2025**
- **Responses:** 156 (19.5% resp. rate)
- **Total Designated CFOs:** 115
- **From Accredited Department:** 72



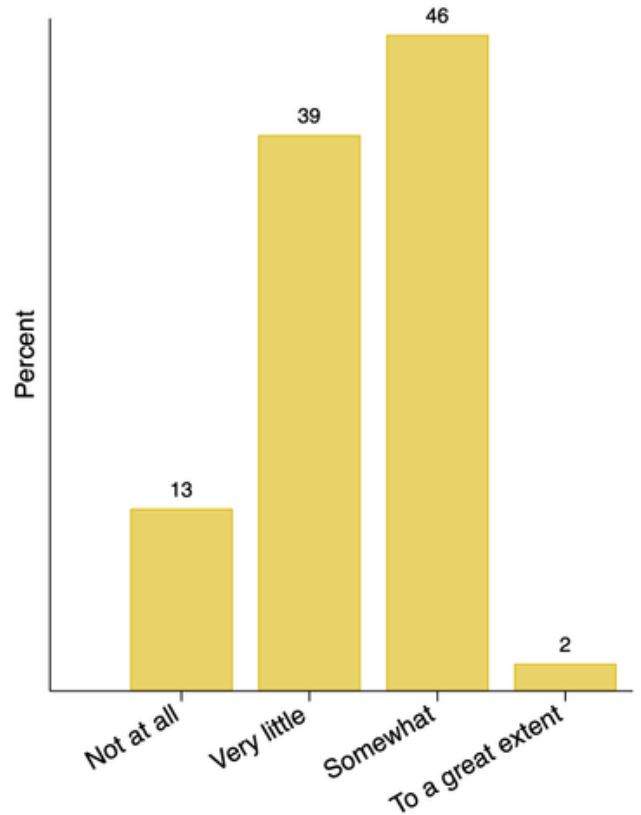
Respondent Service Area Characteristics			
Characteristic	Min.	Max.	Median
Population	1,500	2.2 million	50,000
Square Miles	1.2	22,000	40

AI Use in Fire Departments

Extent of AI Use by Fire Chiefs



Extent of AI Use by Key Personnel

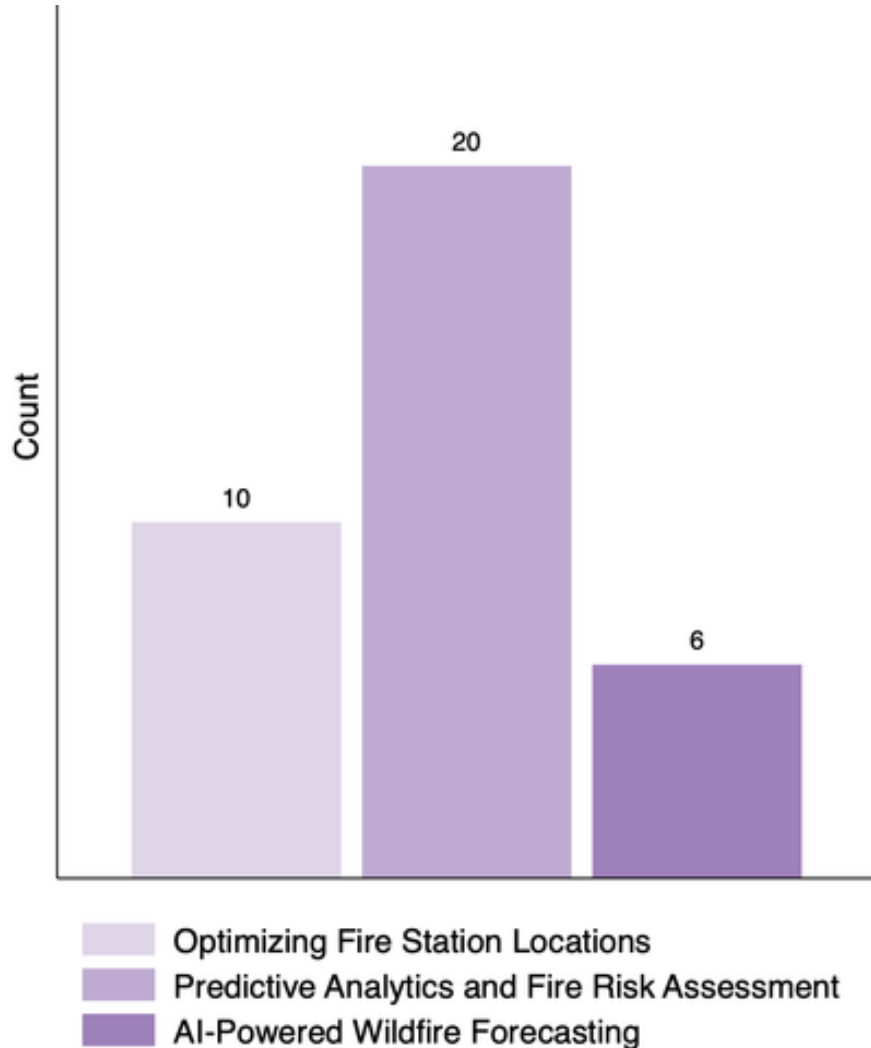


Fire chief
comfort
with AI use



59% Comfortable
18% Uncomfortable

AI Use: Pre-Incident

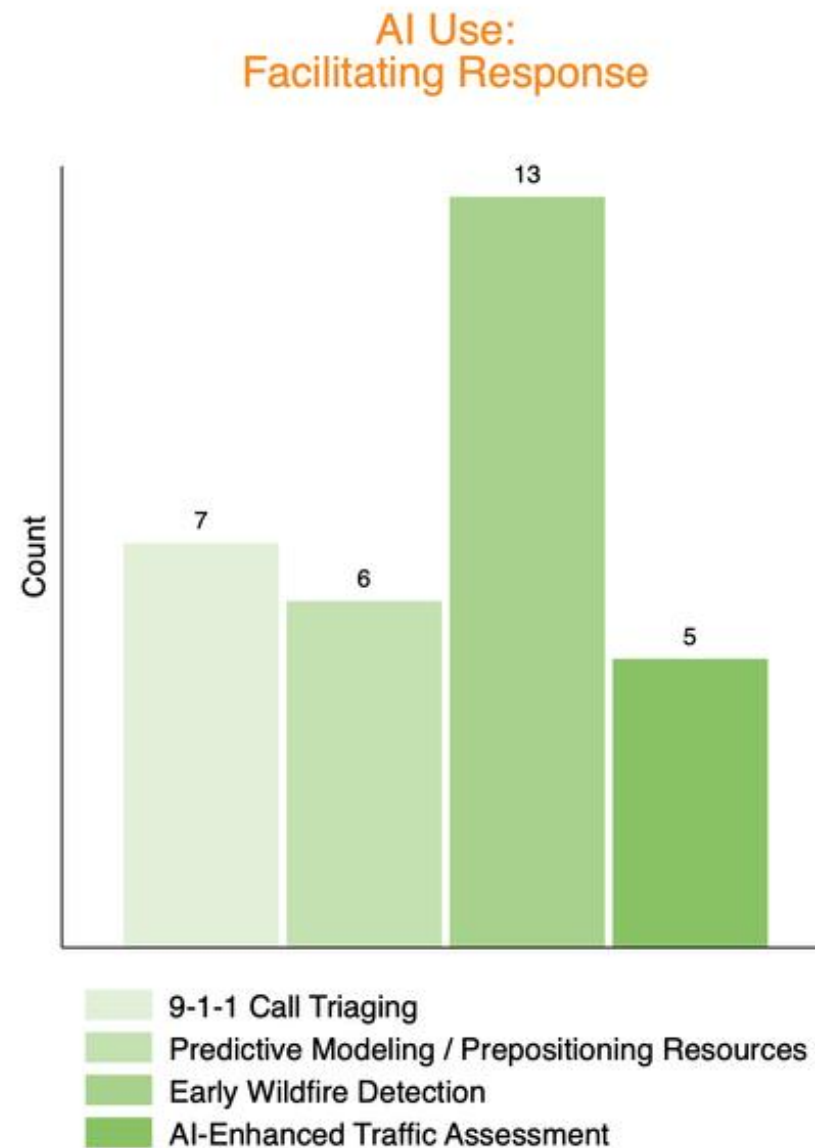


Median number of different AI uses by department  2

Other Pre-Incident AI Uses

- Location modeling / optimizing vehicle deployment
- Vehicle routing

AI Use: Operations

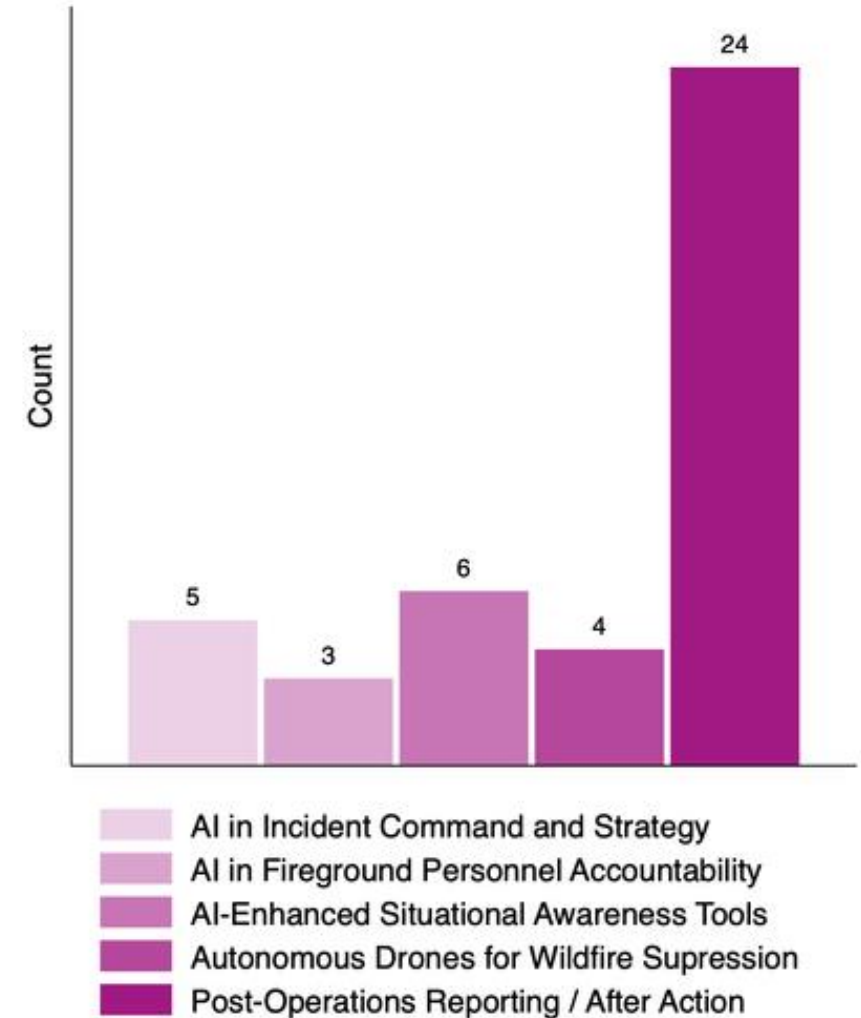


AI Use: Operations

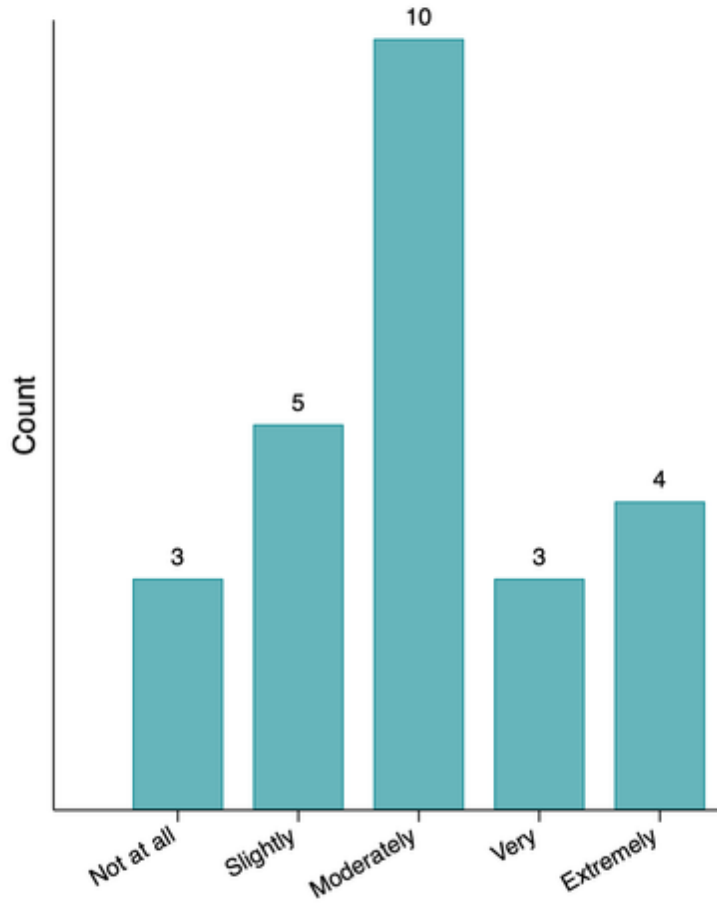
Other Operations AI Uses

- Developing and revising SOPs / SOGs
- Examining turnout time / response time
- Incident command decision support
- Fire behavior modeling
- Examining sleep data
- Using built-in AI in RMS
- AI-assisted ultrasound
- Writing patient care narratives

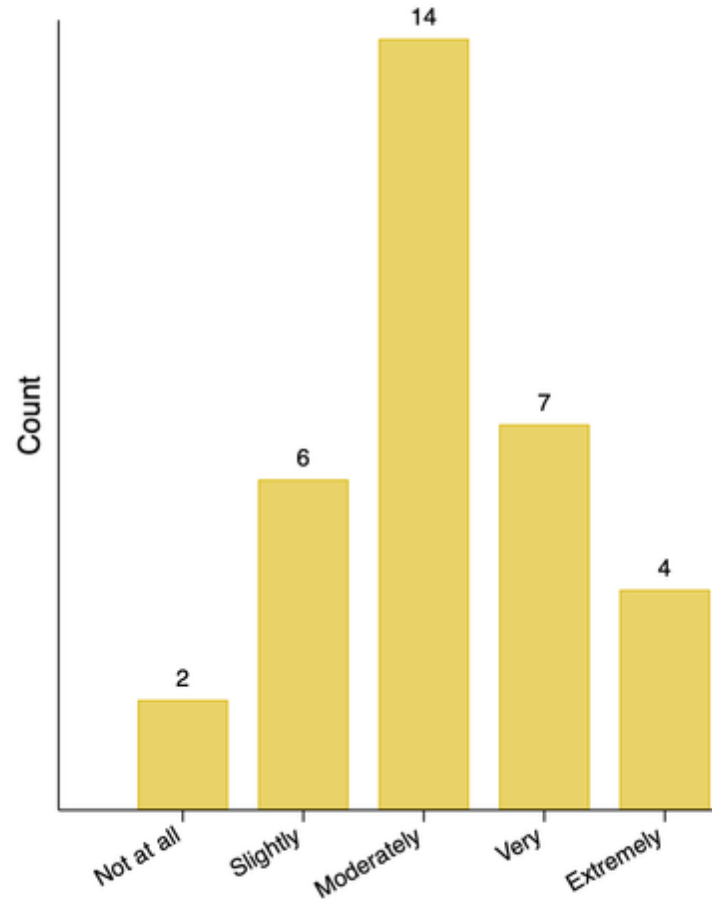
AI Use: Incident Management / After Action



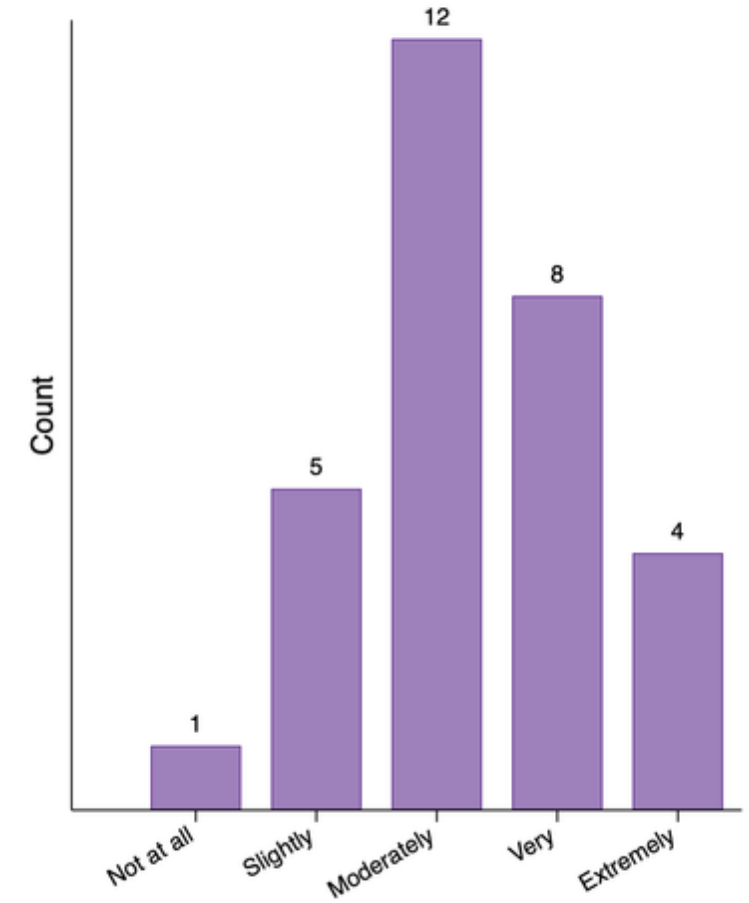
AI Effectiveness:
Improving Response Times



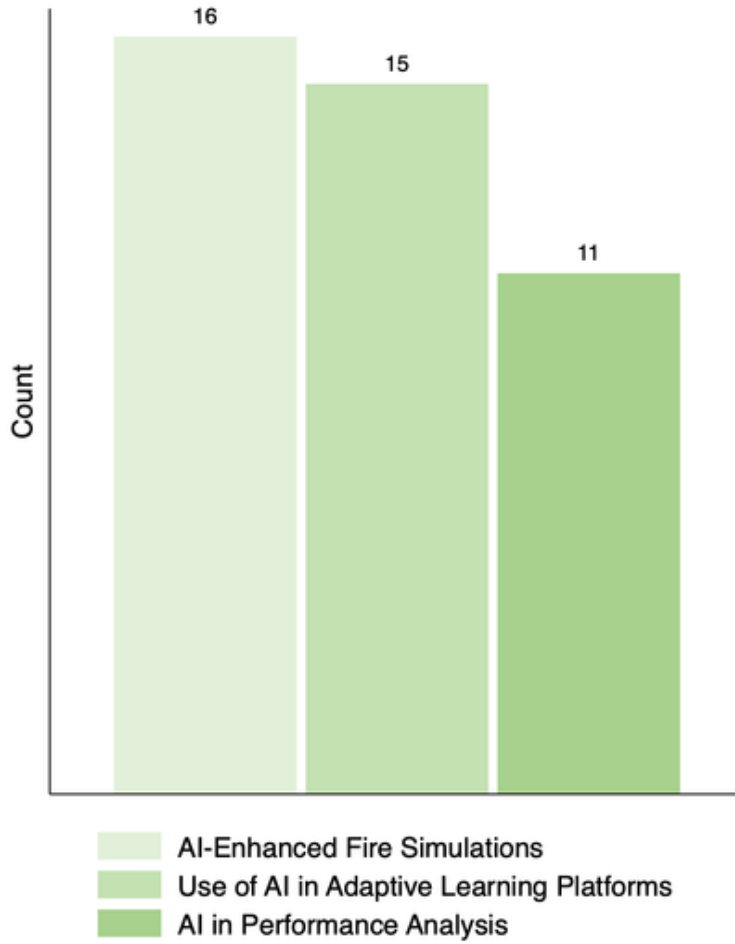
AI Effectiveness:
Improving Situational Awareness



AI Effectiveness:
Improving Decision-Making



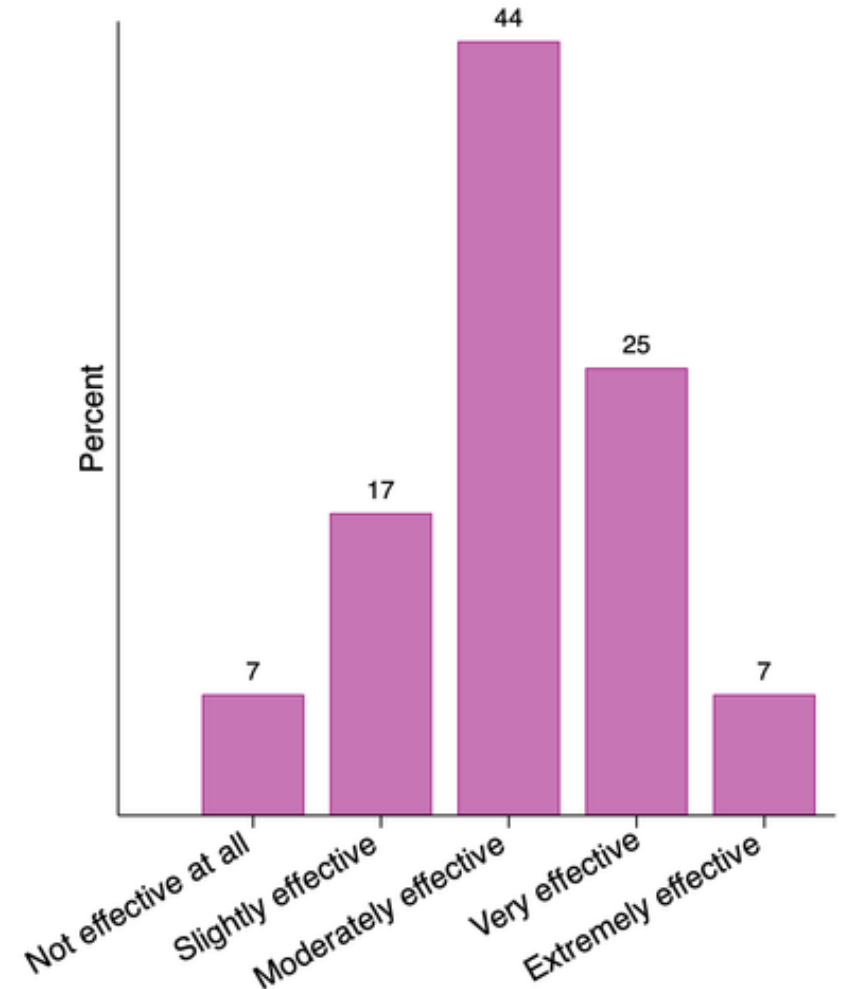
AI Use: Training



Other Training AI Responses

- AI summaries of training information and websites
- Use of AI training to remove bias or fatigue in patient care

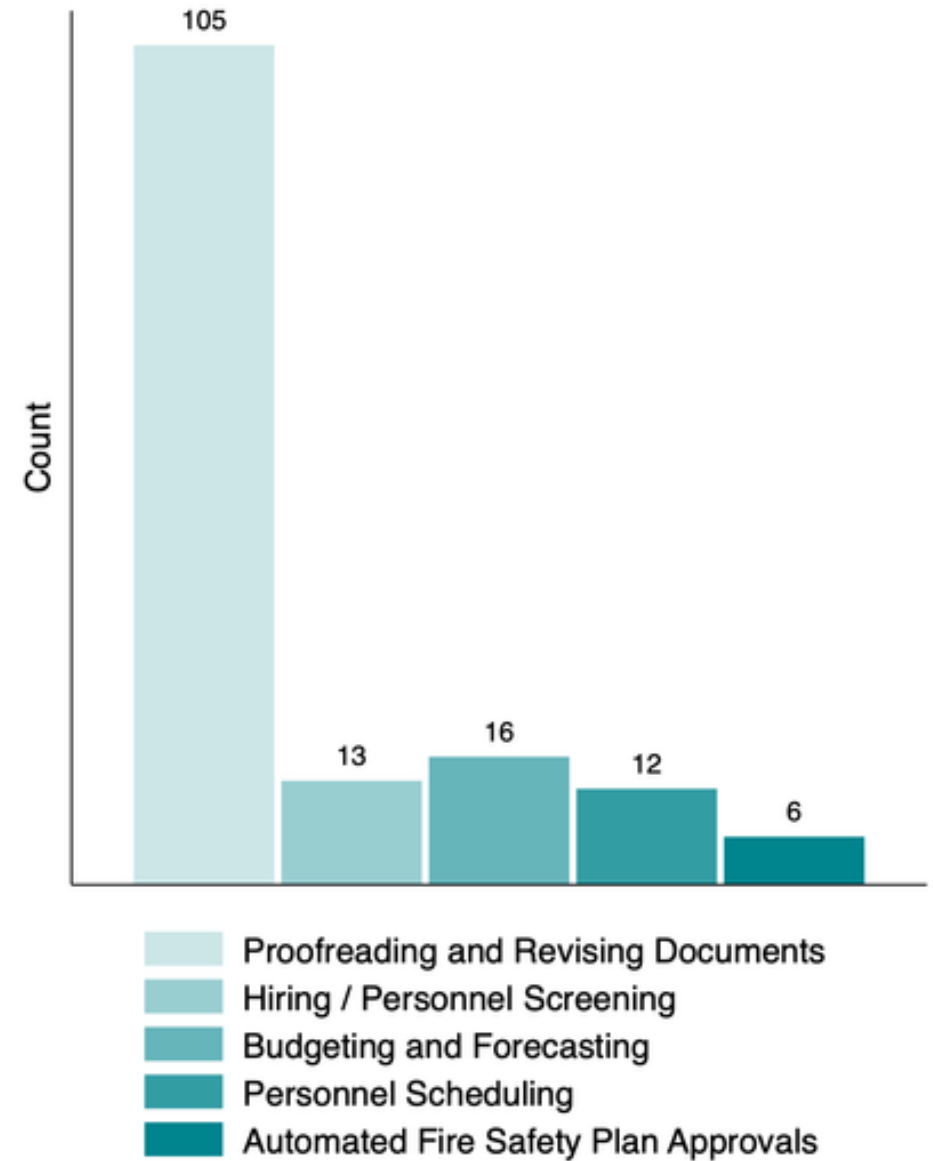
Effectiveness of Fire Training Using AI



AI Use: Admin

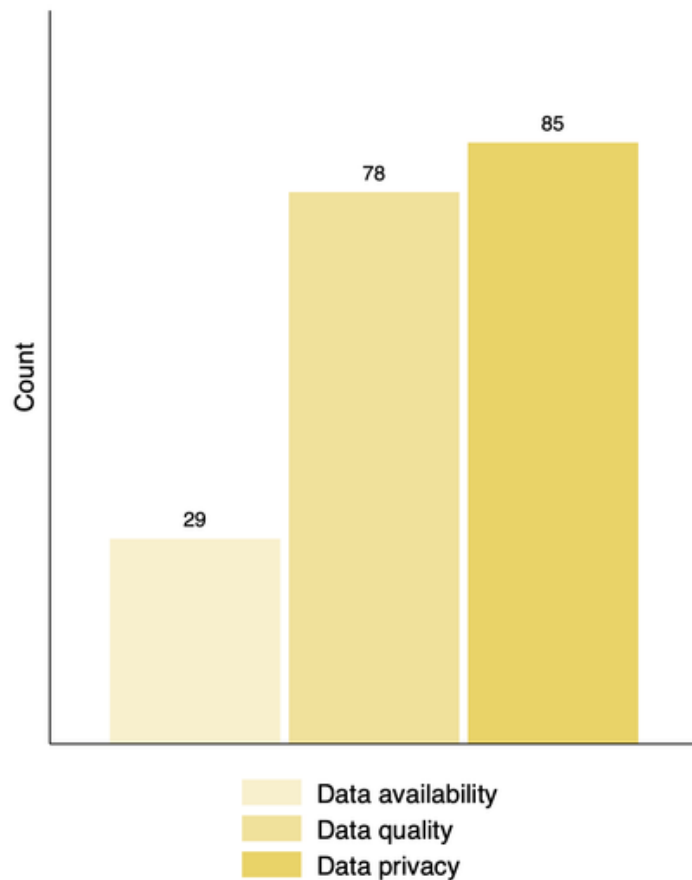
Other Administration AI Uses

- Drafting policies and procedures; job descriptions and performance evals; grant writing; press releases, speeches, social media
- Plan review for citizens to receive code interpretation
- Workflow efficiencies (Microsoft Copilot integration with Office 365)
- Enhanced searches and analysis of documents and research materials
- Research on legal requirements
- Phone answering; translation

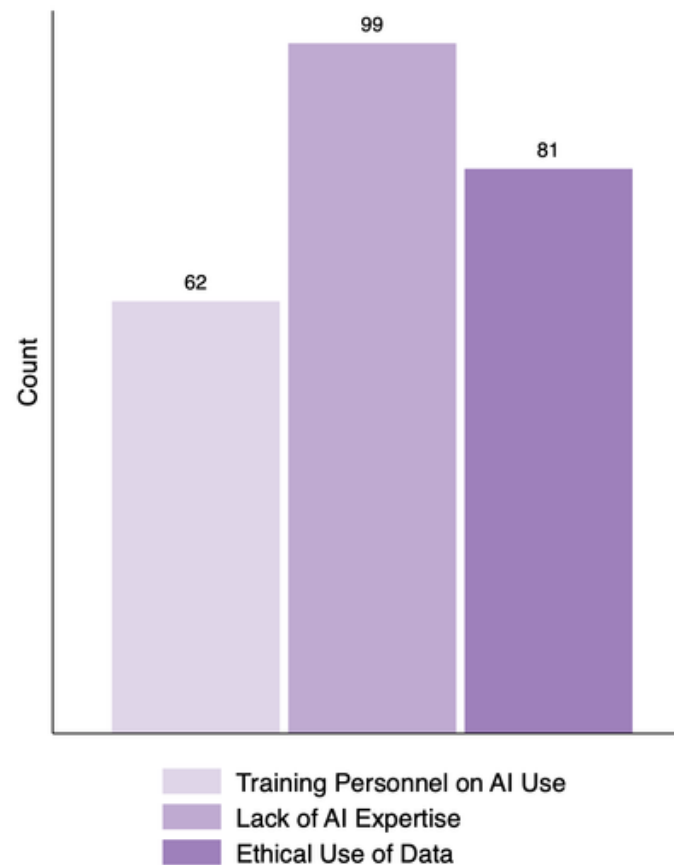


AI Concerns

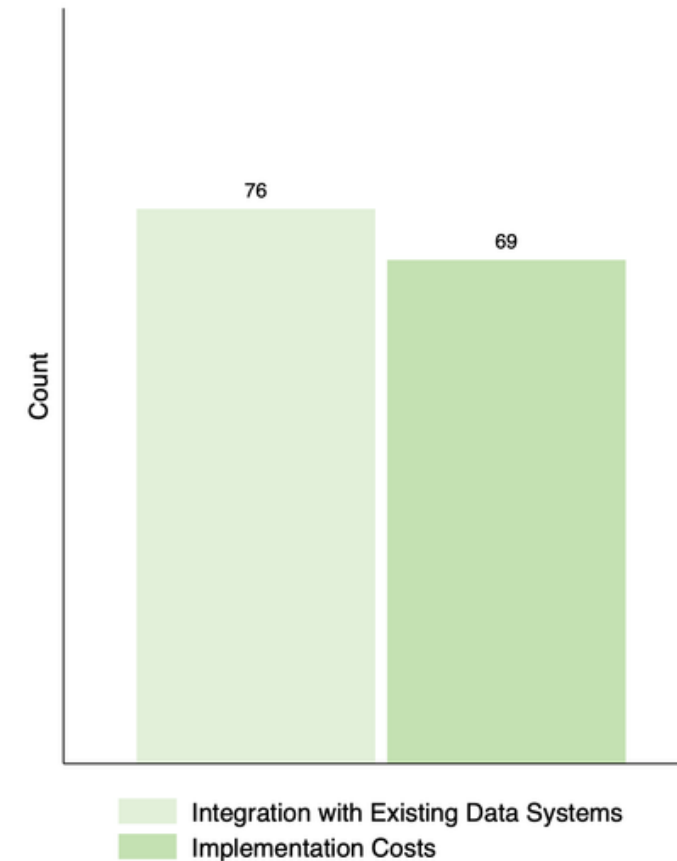
AI Concerns: Data



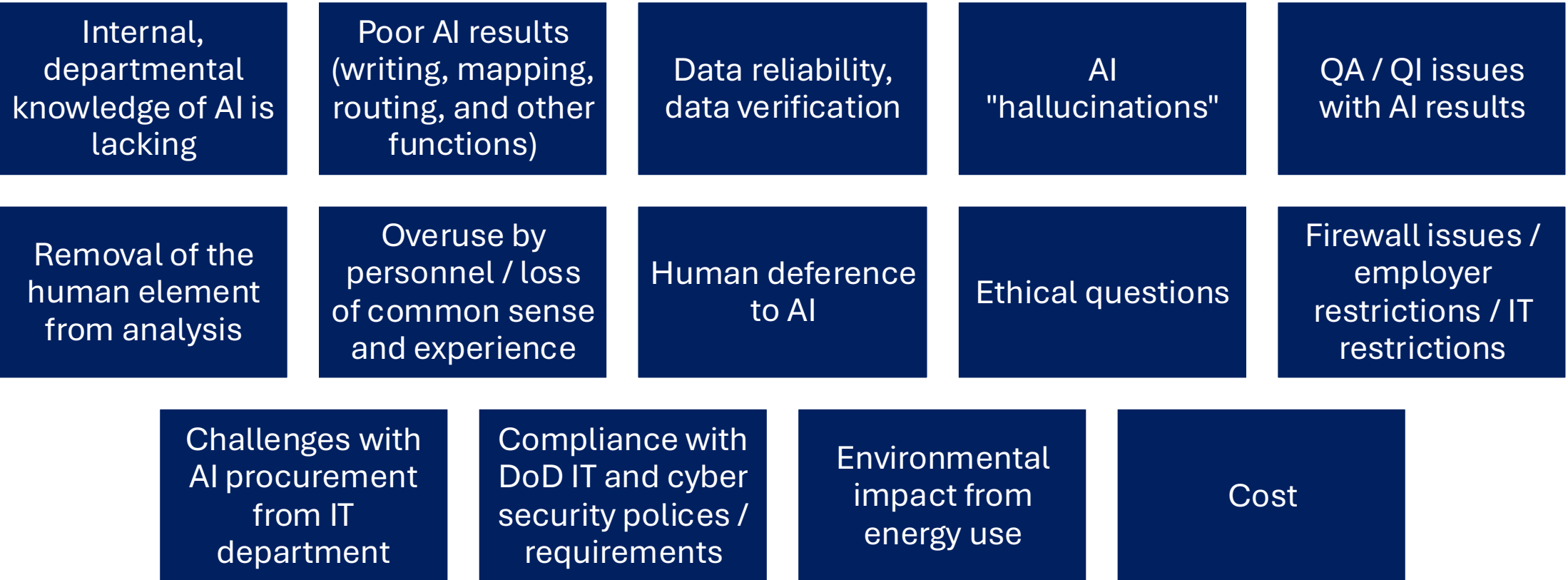
AI Concerns: Personnel and Expertise



AI Concerns: Logistics



Other AI Concerns



AI Policy and Access

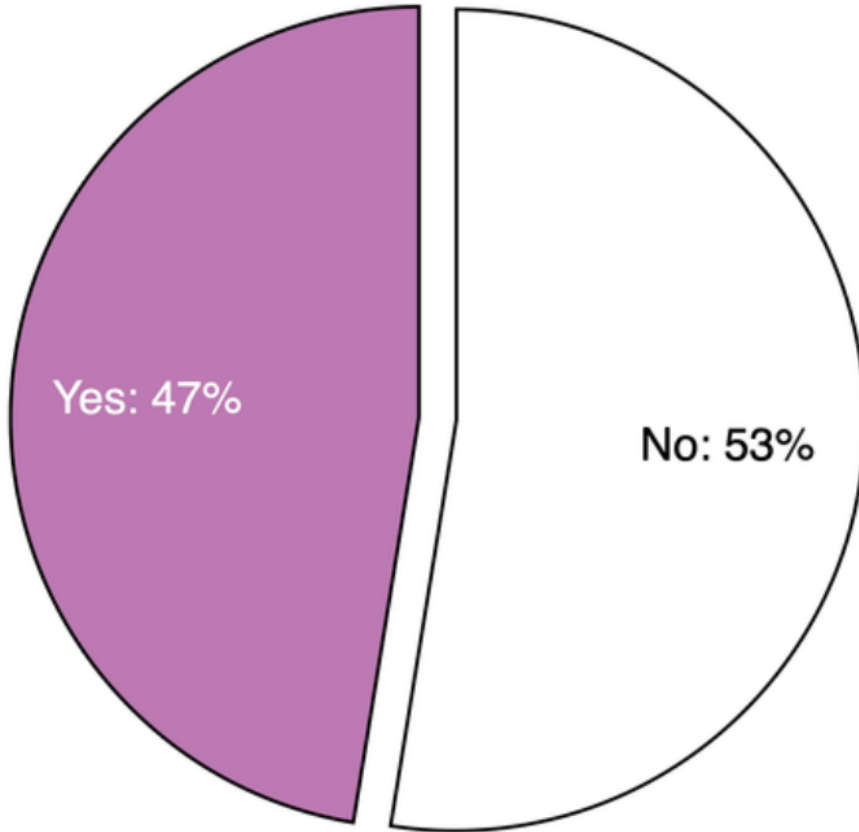
Department has
formal AI policies

14% Yes | 86% No

AHJ provides access
to AI tools

40% Yes | 60% No

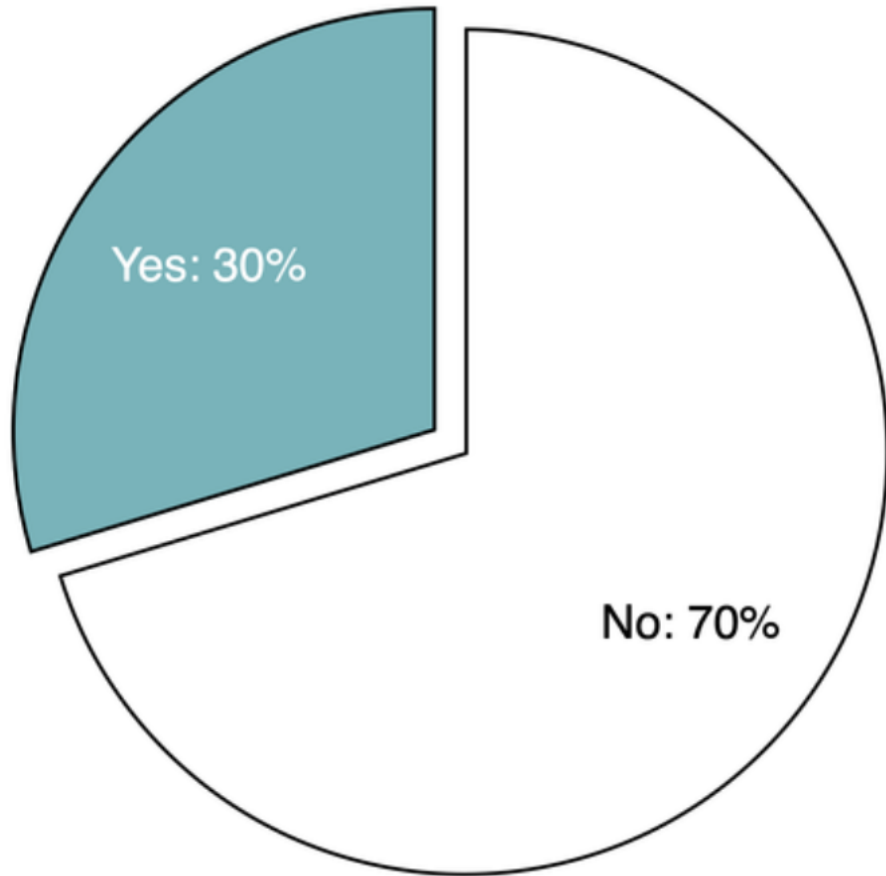
Future Adoption: Ops



Planned Operations Uses:

- Facility hazard risk assessment
- AI in Community Risk Reduction
- AI-assisted 9-1-1 call taking to analyze incident type and response needs
- AI early fire detection / wildland cameras
- Drones as a first responder
- Incident documentation
- AI use for medical report writing
- Patient care reporting quality control
- Interpretive algorithms for cardiac monitor

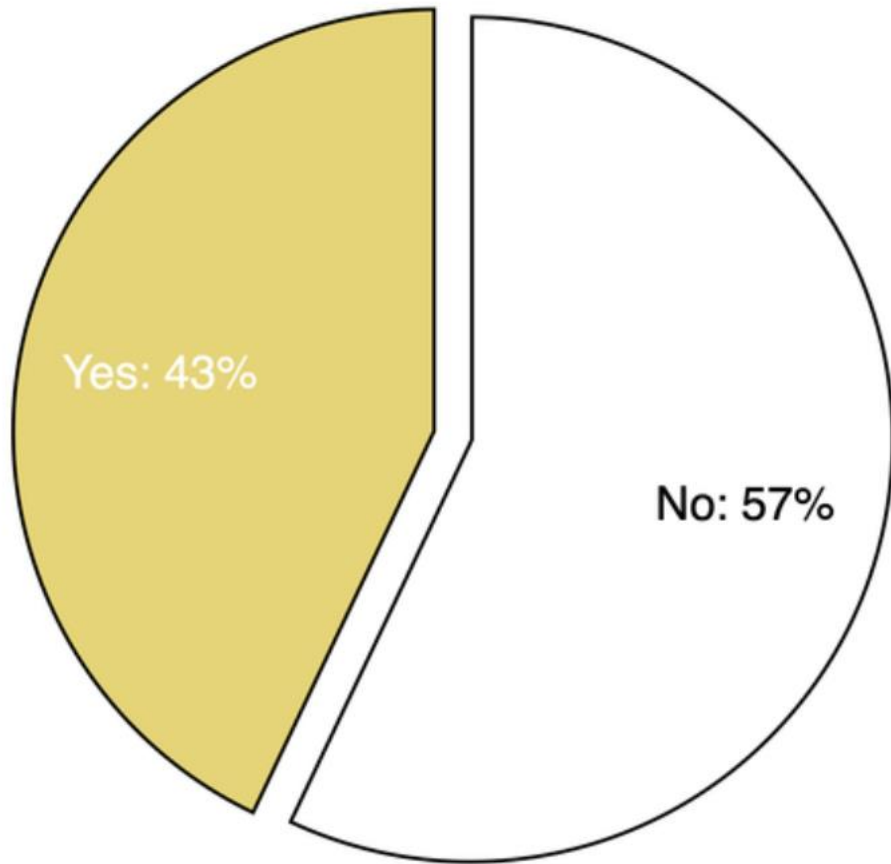
Future Adoption: Training



Planned Training Uses:

- Realistic scenarios / simulation platforms and equipment; VR / AR for incident command, tactics, HAZMAT, EMS
- AI generated images for use in existing fire simulation software
- AI assist in curriculum organization
- Creating training plans
- Job hazard analysis and training design
- Training scheduling
- Post-incident analysis and training recommendations

Future Adoption: Admin



Planned Administration Uses:

- Creating policies, reports, emails, forms, testing and evaluations
- Budgeting and forecasting
- AI for applicant screening, staffing models, personnel scheduling, OT analysis
- AI for fire plan review and approval
- Use of AI in existing products (RMS, CAD)
- Use in writing EMS auto-narratives
- Create an LLM for all meeting recording, minutes, financial documents
- Adoption of new tools: Copilot, Claude, etc.

Actionable Takeaways

- **Pilot Operational AI Use Cases in Low-Risk, High-Impact Areas.**
- Expand AI Training and Capacity Building.
- Develop and Implement Formal AI Policies.
- Prioritize Administrative AI Integration to Free-Up Resources for Field Operations.
- Plan for Scalable AI Infrastructure and Tool Access.

Pilot Operational AI Use Cases in Low-Risk, High-Impact Areas

Pilot

Consider controlled pilots in functions like:

- Wildfire detection
- Resource pre-positioning
- Incident documentation

Assess

Before scaling, assess impact on:

- Response time
- Situational awareness,
- Decision-making

Partner

Consider partnering with vendors or research institutions to test more advanced tools

Actionable Takeaways

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Build the Supporting Infrastructure

Train

Departments should offer hands-on training on specific AI tools in operations, administration, and training, and include ethical AI usage as part of professional development.

Formalize

Agency leaders should create governance frameworks covering AI use, data privacy, and ethical standards, and define approval processes for AI adoption and integration.

Prioritize

Fire chiefs should consider more robust use of AI in administrative tasks in a manner that frees up time and resources for more attention to operational readiness and community engagement.

Formal Policy Consideration

System Elements
Documentation:
procurement, design,
access, and auditing

AI adoption and
integration processes

Systems testing and
ongoing review

Systems training
requirements

Accountability for AI
outcomes use

Communication of
design limitations
and purpose of the
system

11th Edition FESSAM

- 9 Essential Resources
 - 9D Information Technology
 - 9D.6 The agency has a plan to address the ethical use of artificial intelligence (AI) within all operations.

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- **Plan for Scalable AI Infrastructure and Tool Access.**

Plan for Scalable AI & Access

Assess

Consider focused and extensive assessment of existing IT infrastructure for AI compatibility

Budget

Budget for scalable AI solutions with secure integration into RMS, CAD, and communication systems

Collaborate

Pursue collaborative procurement models to reduce individual agency costs

Proven Practices

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FIRE RESCUE 1



How Castle Rock Fire built an AI policy before the tech outpaced governance



AI use case: Johnson City streamlines administrative and code research workflows



Going virtual: Inside 1 fire department's journey into immersive learning





Questions?

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